SYNTHETIC DOCUMENT. NOT A REAL PATIENT. FOR DEMO AND TESTING ONLY.

All names, places and details in this letter are invented.

EXAMPLE GENERAL HOSPITAL (fictional)
Orthopaedic Ward 4

DISCHARGE LETTER

Patient: Margaret Ellis
Date of birth: 3 March 1958 (age 68)
Patient ID: SYN-0001
Admitted: Monday 12 October 2026
Discharged: Friday 16 October 2026
Consultant: Dr R. Sample, Orthopaedic Surgeon

PROCEDURE

Right total knee replacement on Monday 12 October 2026. The operation went as planned. No complications.

MEDICINES TO TAKE AT HOME

1. Paracetamol 500 mg tablets. Take 2 tablets four times a day (morning, midday, evening, bedtime) for 14 days. Take the morning dose after breakfast.
2. Codeine 30 mg tablets. Take 1 tablet up to four times a day, only if needed for pain. Stop after 5 days.
3. Apixaban 2.5 mg tablets. Take 1 tablet twice a day (morning and evening). Take the morning dose after breakfast. Continue as directed.
4. Senna 7.5 mg tablets. Take 2 tablets at bedtime if constipated.

DAILY ACTIVITIES

- Knee exercises from your physiotherapy sheet: three times a day (morning, afternoon, evening).
- Walking: one short walk of 5 to 10 minutes, twice a day, using your walking frame. Times agreed with you on the ward: 7:30 am, before breakfast, and 3:00 pm.
- Ice pack on the knee for 20 minutes after each set of exercises.
- Rest with your leg raised between activities.

DIET

- Eat plenty of fibre, such as fruit, vegetables and wholegrain bread, to help prevent constipation from your pain medicine.
- Drink 6 to 8 glasses of water or other fluids a day.
- Do not drink alcohol while you are taking codeine.

WOUND CARE

- Keep the dressing clean and dry. Do not remove it yourself.
- Your wound clips will be removed on Monday 26 October 2026.

RESTRICTIONS

- Do not drive until your consultant has reviewed you at your 6-week appointment and told you it is safe.
- Do not kneel on the operated knee.
- Do not have a bath or go swimming until the wound has healed. Showering is fine if the dressing stays dry.

FOLLOW-UP APPOINTMENTS

- Physiotherapy: Thursday 22 October 2026, 2:00 pm, Outpatient Physiotherapy, Example General Hospital.
- Wound clip removal: Monday 26 October 2026, 10:30 am, practice nurse at your local surgery.
- Consultant review: Monday 23 November 2026, 9:15 am, Orthopaedic Clinic, Example General Hospital.

WARNING SIGNS

Call the ward on 0000 000 000 (fictional number) if you have:

- Pain, swelling, redness or heat in your calf.
- Redness, swelling or fluid leaking from the wound.
- A temperature of 38°C or higher.
- Pain that your medicines do not control.

Call emergency services straight away if you have chest pain or sudden shortness of breath.

Signed: Dr R. Sample, Orthopaedic Surgeon

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